

Basement

Story Context

Deep inside the house, the sheriff reaches the basement.

A locked terminal flickers in the dark.

It asks for a password.

But a strange message appears:

"not everything that opens the door reveals the truth"

Something is wrong...

Not all answers are real.

Objective

Analyze the binary and find the **real flag**.

Files Provided

Description.txt

basement_lock

Step 1 — Run the Binary

```
chmod +x basement_lock  
./basement_lock
```

Try random input:

hello

Output:

Access Denied

Step 2 — Think Like a Reverser

Clue:

not everything that opens the door reveals the truth

Meaning:

- There may be **fake success**
 - Need deeper analysis
-

Step 3 — Extract Strings

```
strings basement_lock
```

Output contains:

```
open_sesame  
THM{this_is_not_the_real_flag}  
shadowkeeper  
THM{b453m3nt_kn0ws_th3_truth}
```

Step 4 — Identify Possible Passwords

From strings:

- `open_sesame`
 - `shadowkeeper`
-

Step 5 — Try First Password (Trap)

`./basement_lock`

Input:

`open_sesame`

Output:

Access Granted

THM{this_is_not_the_real_flag}

This is a **FAKE FLAG**

Step 6 — Understand the Trick

Clue told us:

not everything that opens the door reveals the truth

So:

- First password = trap
- Flag = fake

Step 7 — Try Second Password

`./basement_lock`

Input:

shadowkeeper

Output:

System Override

THM{b453m3nt_kn0ws_th3_truth}

FINAL FLAG

THM{b453m3nt_kn0ws_th3_truth}

Questions

1. What command can be used to extract readable strings from the binary?

Ans: strings

2. What is the real flag revealed by the system?

Ans: THM{b453m3nt_kn0ws_th3_truth}